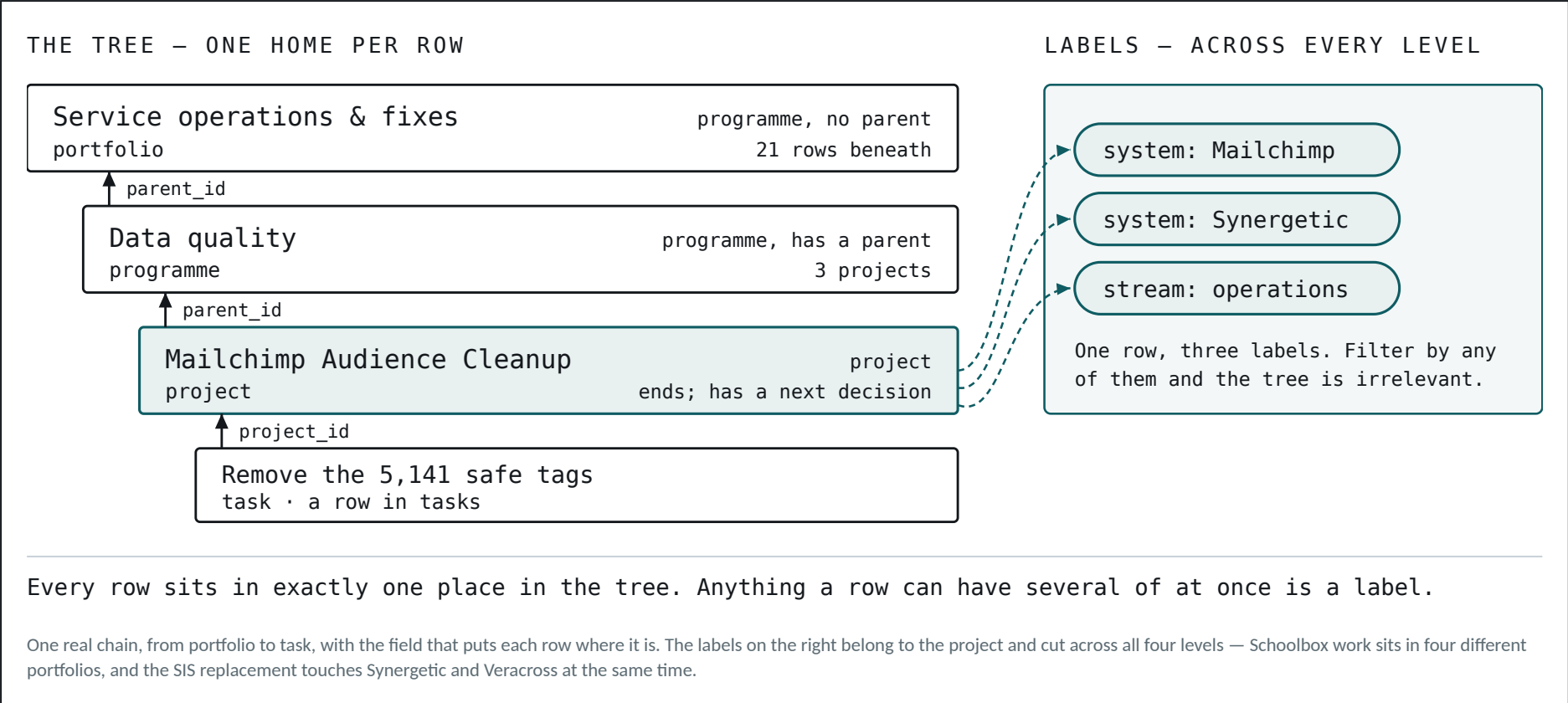


How work is filed

Four levels, four tests. Settled while restructuring the portfolio, and written down so the next filing decision takes seconds rather than an argument.

6 portfolios
11 programmes
70 live rows
254 open tasks



1 Portfolio

Why the work exists. Stable for a year or more, and the level you report against.

THE TEST	Would this heading still make sense in twelve months, and would Paul recognise it without explanation?
IN THE DATA	project_type = 'programme' with parent_id empty
HOW IT ENDS	It doesn't go green. It gets re-scoped, or retired.
EXAMPLE	Service operations & fixes — 21 rows beneath it
EXCEPTION	SIS replacement will genuinely finish. When it does, the portfolio retires.

2 Programme

A grouping that earns its keep. Projects that must be sequenced or traded off against each other.

THE TEST	Do these projects compete for the same time and attention, or would a shared label do just as well?
IN THE DATA	project_type = 'programme' with a parent
HOLDS	Almost no work of its own — only genuinely cross-cycle items
EXAMPLE	Student report checks: each term's cycle is a project beneath it
IF A LABEL WOULD DO	It is not a programme. Tag it and leave it where it is.

3 Project

A deliverable with an end and a next decision. One finishable thing.

THE TEST	Can you name the state in which you would archive it?
IN THE DATA	project_type = 'project'
IF IT NEVER ENDS	It is a service line, and belongs in Service operations & fixes
EXAMPLE	Timetabling Solutions — v10 migration
THE SPLIT TEST	The migration ends. The daily imports and incidents do not. Two rows.

4 Task

One bounded piece of work inside a project. A person, a sitting or two, no decision of its own.

THE TEST	Does it need its own next decision and its own children?
IN THE DATA	A row in tasks, always under exactly one project
IF YES TO THE TEST	It is a project, not a task
EXAMPLE	Upgrade React Router v6 to v7 — one job, one deliverable
NOT A TASK	Anything with sub-parts you would want to track separately

Operational The third value of project_type, and not a level at all. A standing line of work that runs on a calendar or a queue rather than towards a finish — the BIM budget, term and semester changeover. It sits inside a portfolio like anything else.

RULE ONE

More than one at once means it is a label

If a row can carry several of something at the same time, it is not a level in the tree. Systems are the case that proves it: systems text[] on the project, surfaced in the Streams view, rather than a branch above it.

RULE TWO

One axis per portfolio, declared once

SIS replacement divides by system. Data governance by discipline. Reporting and analytics by audience. Different axes across portfolios are fine. Undeclared axes are what turn filing into an argument.

The six portfolios:

SIS replacement Data governance Team and capability Systems Service operations & fixes Reporting and analytics